FREE PLAYABLE SAMPLE

THE CASE LIBRARY

ONE CASE / HINTS / EXPLAINED SOLUTION



Read the evidence. Challenge the alibi. Explain the answer.

ILLUSTRATED PDF GAME | ENGLISH | REVIEW EDITION

Open a file. Find the flaw.



Atmospheric artwork. Use the written exhibits for every clue.

A convincing account is not always a reliable one. Compare interviews with the supplied records, identify the visitor and explain which fact defeats the strongest competing explanation.

This is a collection of short, self-contained fictional detective puzzles for solo or cooperative play. It is designed around reading, comparing records and writing deductions. It is not a role-playing dinner kit, a novel, a police training manual or an app. No host, acting or internet connection is required after download.

All necessary facts are supplied. Some cases use explicit artificial puzzle rules. Reasoning skills recur across the collection; these are not 120 different game systems. Generated atmospheric artwork is decorative and never contains essential clues.

REVIEW STATUS

This revised edition is prepared for independent testing. Difficulty and completion times have not been calibrated with players. Human playtesting, actual reader-device checks and the seller's payment and legal setup are not yet verified. Do not present this review copy as an independently validated commercial release.

The fair-play agreement

1 / A closed fictional case

Exactly one listed suspect is responsible for the fatal encounter described in each file. There are no unlisted entrants, unseen accomplices or hidden delayed mechanisms. A supplied fatal interval and expressly verified observations are reliable facts for this game.

2 / Facts are different from claims

Interview statements can be mistaken or false. Use evidence expressly described as checked, verified or a fixed puzzle condition. No outside forensic, legal, historical or technical knowledge is necessary. Do not invent exceptions to the supplied route or time models.

3 / Build an explanation

Read the briefing and evidence, then use the investigation page or a notebook. Name the culprit, cite the decisive exhibits and explain why another plausible candidate fails. A motive or suspicious possession alone is insufficient.

4 / Reveal deliberately

Hints and solutions are behind the spoiler divider. Each hint page precedes a separate solution page. Hint 3 may effectively reveal the decisive step; cover lower hints if you want only a small nudge. A PDF cannot prevent scrolling into spoilers.

5 / Device and print use

Download before writing. A reader with PDF-form support can save your notes. Some phone and browser previews do not save fields. Use a notebook if needed, or print selected investigation pages. Never print the answer section into a player pack by accident.

6 / Audience

These fictional cases contain non-graphic death, deception and financial disputes. Suggested audience: older teens and adults, with an adult choosing suitability for younger players. No measured age rating, playing time or independently calibrated difficulty is claimed.

Investigations 001-001

Every case stands alone. Select a title; bookmarks provide another route.

001 The Last Light at Halcyon House 5

STANDARD / A COASTAL HOUSE DURING A RESTORATION FUNDRAISER

The Last Light at Halcyon House

Someone remembers a room they insist they never entered.



Atmospheric artwork. Use the written exhibits for every clue.

At 21:18, auction specialist Elliot Vale is found dead in the reading room of Halcyon House. He had promised to expose a false attribution before the evening auction. A steward spoke to him in that room at 21:10; a continuous corridor recording establishes that the fatal encounter occurred between 21:11 and 21:17. The room has one usable entrance. Four people had argued with Elliot. Your task is to identify his visitor, explain the revealing mistake in their account, and distinguish evidence from motive.

THE PEOPLE IN THE FILE

Ada Wren / Conservator

I last entered the reading room at 19:40. Elliot was alive. I spent the later interval alone in the workroom.

Nora Bell / House manager

The auction could save my job. I was dealing with a supplier at the gate.

Luca Reed / Art dealer

Elliot threatened my reputation, but I was introducing the next lot in the ballroom.

Finn Vale / Elliot's nephew

We quarrelled about a loan. I went upstairs with my luggage.

The evidence file

Read exact wording, source labels and times. Interview claims are not automatically established facts.

A1 | Corridor review

Two independent reviewers confirm that the only visitor between 21:11 and 21:17 came from the workroom corridor and returned that way. The figure is obscured by a trolley; no face is visible. No other entry or exit occurred. The windows were secured throughout.

A2 | Furniture movement

At 20:35, two stewards moved the small green-shaded lamp from the drawing room to Elliot's desk. Their signed work sheet and photographs establish the time. Before that, the reading-room desk had a tall white lamp. Ada's earlier visit ended at 19:40.

A3 | Interview supplement

Asked whether she noticed anything unusual on her last visit, Ada says: "The green desk lamp was on. Elliot pushed its shade away to read the auction sheet." The interviewer had not mentioned either lamp. Ada says she did not see the room again after 19:40. The room is not visible from the workroom or terrace.

A4 | Independent alibis

A gate attendant and gate video place Nora there from 21:08 to 21:19. The ballroom recording shows Luca continuously on stage from 21:09 to 21:20. An upstairs steward, supported by corridor video, stays with Finn from 21:07 to 21:18. None can reach the reading room without leaving those observations.

A5 | The disputed painting

An unsent message on Elliot's laptop says Ada had substituted a reproduction for a privately owned watercolour. A dated conservation ledger confirms she had custody of that work. This supplies a possible motive; the message alone would not prove a killing.

NOTES ON THE EXHIBITS

Build your explanation

1. Who had the opportunity to visit Elliot?

YOUR ANSWER

2. What makes the lamp statement important?

YOUR ANSWER

3. Which exhibit establishes a possible motive, and why is it insufficient alone?

YOUR ANSWER

YOUR FINAL ACCUSATION

DECISIVE EXHIBIT REFERENCES

STRONGEST ALTERNATIVE AND WHY IT FAILS

Before revealing: can you explain the key contradiction without inventing a fact? Use the answer directory at the back for this case's hints. Solutions are on separate pages.

Close the file before the reveal



Atmospheric artwork. Use the written exhibits for every clue.

Everything after this page can reveal a solution. Make your accusation first. Use the linked hint directory to open just the case you need; avoid browsing past another answer.

Return to the case directory

Hints 001-001

Open hints first. The following page contains the full solution.

001 The Last Light at Halcyon House 10

The Last Light at Halcyon House

Stop after the first useful nudge. Cover lower hints with a sheet of paper or the edge of the screen. Hint 3 may reveal most of the solution.

HINT 1

Separate the fatal interval from the much earlier quarrels.

HINT 2

Compare Ada's claimed last visit with the furniture movement.

HINT 3

A3 describes a change that happened after Ada says she stopped visiting. Read it alongside A1 and A4.

Open the full solution deliberately

Return to the investigation

SPOILERS

The Last Light at Halcyon House

THE CULPRIT

Ada Wren

THE COMPLETE DEDUCTION

Ada is the only suspect not continuously accounted for elsewhere during the fatal interval, and A1 gives the visitor's route as the workroom corridor. Her description of the green lamp contradicts her claimed last visit: it arrived fifty-five minutes later. The room had no outside sightline, and the interviewer did not supply the detail. In the closed set of this case, opportunity plus that concealed later visit identifies Ada. The conservation records explain why she wanted Elliot silenced.

CHECK THE ALTERNATIVES

Nora, Luca and Finn each have a continuous, independently supported alibi covering the entire fatal interval. Their financial or reputational problems do not overcome those records. The trolley obscures identity; it is not proof against whichever person happens to own a similar trolley.

THE FILE CLOSES

The decisive detail was ordinary furniture. An attentive investigator noticed that Ada remembered the room more accurately than her story allowed.

Return to this case